

Day 8 — The HTTP Request Node & Authentication

Weather Notification Automation — calling an external API from n8n and handling authentication

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Authentication Method

WeatherAPI.com uses API key authentication passed as a query parameter (?key= . . .), rather than a header-based Bearer token or full OAuth2 flow. In n8n, this was implemented using the HTTP Request node's built-in **"Generic Credential Type → Query Auth"** option, so the API key is stored securely as a reusable n8n credential and never appears in plain text inside the workflow JSON, the node parameters, or any exported file.

Screenshot 1 — Successful Workflow Execution

The screenshot displays the n8n web interface in a browser window. The workflow, titled "wheather notification automation", is shown in the "Editor" tab. It consists of four nodes: "Schedule Trigger", "Weather API (HTTP Request)", "Check If Rain Expected", and "Send Notification". The "Weather API" node is configured with a URL "https://api.weatherapi.com/v1/forecast.json?lat=33.4497&lon=73.8475&key=...". The "Check If Rain Expected" node has a condition "true". The "Send Notification" node is configured to send a message via email. The workflow is executed successfully, and the "Logs" panel shows the execution details. The "OUTPUT" panel displays the following data:

timestamp	Readable date	Readable time	Day of week	Year	Month	Day of month	Hour	Minute
2026-08-08T04:15:58.973-04:00	August 8th 2026, 4:15:58 am	4:15:58 am	Saturday	2026	August	08	04	15

The bottom of the screenshot shows the Windows taskbar with the system clock indicating 1:17 AM on 8/8/2026.

Screenshot 2 — Alert Email Received

